

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE: CYBERSECURITY INCIDENT RESPONSE

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Classification: Internal / Policy

Framework: NIST SP 800-61 Rev. 2

1. DOCUMENT CONTROL & EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Document Title	Cybersecurity Incident Response Standard Operating Procedure (IR-SOP)
Effective Date	September 1, 2026
Document Owner	Information Security Lead / CSIRT Lead
Scope	All enterprise networks, cloud workloads, assets, and personnel globally.
Primary Objective	Minimize operational disruption, contain adversary activity, enforce legal/regulatory compliance, and preserve digital evidence during security incidents.

2. INCIDENT SEVERITY CLASSIFICATION FRAMEWORK

Severity Level	Impact Criteria	Response SLA	Escalation Target
SEV-1 (Critical)	Active ransomware, domain compromise, mass PII/data exfiltration, complete service outage.	< 15 Minutes	CISO, Executive Team, Legal Counsel

Severity Level	Impact Criteria	Response SLA	Escalation Target
SEV-2 (High)	Single server compromise, unauthorized privileged access, contained malware outbreak.	< 1 Hour	Security Lead, IT Infrastructure Lead
SEV-3 (Medium)	Isolated phishing attempt with credential submission, missing critical patches.	< 4 Hours	SOC Tier 2 / Security Analyst
SEV-4 (Low)	Policy violation, routine adware/malware block on endpoint.	< 24 Hours	SOC Tier 1 Analyst

3. INCIDENT RESPONSE LIFE CYCLE (NIST SP 800-61 PHASE EXECUTION)

Phase 1: Preparation

- Maintain central SIEM logging (60-day hot retention, 365-day cold archive).
- Deploy Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) agents to 100% of managed hosts.
- Conduct mandatory quarterly tabletop IR exercises for the CSIRT team.

Phase 2: Detection & Analysis

- Triage alerts from EDR, SIEM, and CloudTrail within designated Severity SLAs.
- Perform triage to confirm IOCs (IP addresses, file hashes, C2 communications).
- Scope lateral movement using active memory analysis and forensic log correlation.

Phase 3: Containment, Eradication & Recovery

- **Short-Term Containment:** Isolate compromised hosts via EDR agent isolation; revoke compromised Kerberos/OAuth tokens immediately.
- **Eradication:** Terminate malicious processes, delete unauthorized scheduled tasks/services, and patch exploited vulnerabilities.

- ## Phase 4: Post-Incident Activity

- #### 4. GOVERNANCE APPROVAL & AUDIT SIGN-OFF

Prepared By: François Xavier Talla Tamo, PMP®
 Role: Information Security Specialist
 Approval Date: September 1, 2026
 Review Cycle: Annual (Next Scheduled Review: Q3 2027)

This Standard Operating Procedure has been reviewed and formally approved for enterprise operational use. Compliance with this document is mandatory for all Information Technology and Cybersecurity personnel.

Date: Sep 1, 2026